

Ἀλβῖνος ὁ Πλατωνικός

Albinus the Platonist on the Doctrines of Plato

eul_aid: qhm

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Φιλοσοφική Ἀττική [Attic Philosophical](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Platonist](#)

Albinus was a Platonist philosopher active in the Roman Empire during the 2nd century CE. He taught in the city of Smyrna in Asia Minor and was a student of the prominent teacher Gaius. A key biographical fact is that he was an instructor of the famous physician Galen around the year 144 CE, which helps date his career to the middle of that century. He is considered a representative figure of Middle Platonism, a phase of Platonic thought between the early Academy and later Neoplatonism.

His surviving work is a short handbook titled *Prolégomena to the Philosophy of Plato*, which served as an introduction for new students. It explains the nature of Plato's dialogues, suggests an order for reading them, and outlines the qualities needed to study philosophy. This text provides direct insight into the teaching methods of Platonists in his era.

A longer, systematic summary of Platonic doctrine called the *Epitome of Plato's Doctrines* was traditionally attributed to Albinus, but modern scholars, based on manuscript evidence, now attribute this work to another 2nd-century philosopher named Alcinous.

Albinus is significant for understanding how Platonic philosophy was organized and taught. His genuine *Prolégomena* reveals a structured curriculum designed to guide students. His influence extended into medicine and science through his pupil Galen. The *Epitome*, long thought to be his, was used for centuries as a standard handbook of Platonic ideas, impacting later philosophers and early Christian thinkers. His career exemplifies the active philosophical culture in the Greek-speaking world under Roman rule.

Works (2)

- Εἰσαγωγή εἰς τοὺς Πλάτωνος διαλόγους · [Introduction to the Dialogues of Plato](#) · 7 passages
- Διδασκαλικὸς τῶν Πλάτωνος δογμάτων · [Teaching of Plato's Doctrines](#) · 110 passages

Other Platonist Authors

- Ἀλέξανδρος Λυκοπολίτης · [Alexander of Lycopolis](#) · 1 work
- Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς τὸν Πλάτωνος Θεαίτητον · [Anonymous Commentary on Plato](#) · 1 work
- Ἀρίμνηστος · [Arimnestus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- Ἀττικός · [Atticus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- Κάσσιος Λογγίνος · [Cassius Longinus the Philosopher](#) · 3 works

- Κέλσος ὁ Πλατωνικός · Celsus the Platonist · 1 work
- Κράντωρ ὁ Σολεύς · Crantor of Soli · 2 works
- Εὐδρόμος · Eudromus the Philosopher · 1 work
- Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus · 2 works
- Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus II · 1 work
- Ἡρακλείδης ὁ Ποντικός · Heraclides of Pontus III · 1 work
- Ἀνώνυμος Προλεγόμενα εἰς τὴν Πλατωνικὴν Φιλοσοφίαν · Introduction Platonism Anonymous · 1 work